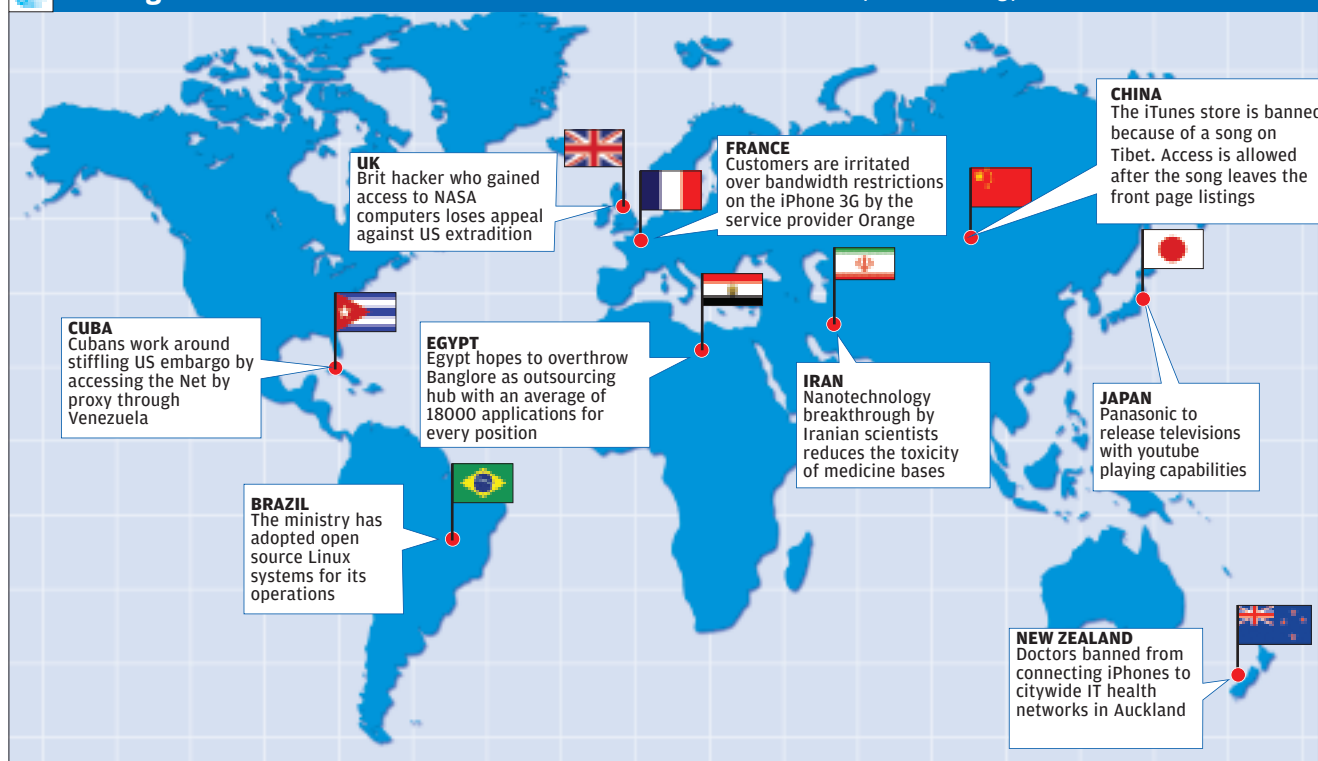


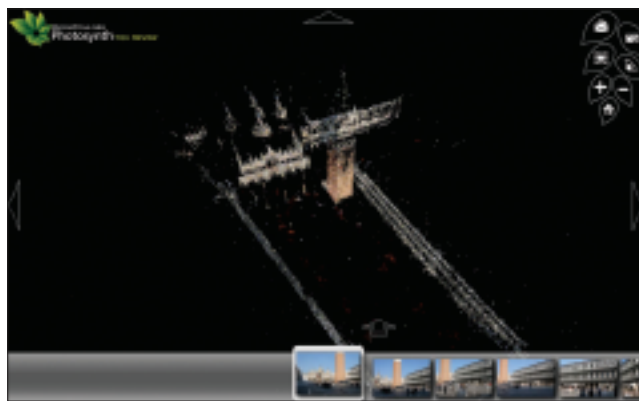


Rs 19,230. According to Dell, there are more cheaper models in the offing. However, in China, Lenovo is selling basic PCs in the same market for as low as Rs 9,650. These machines are not available in India.

3D PHOTO BROWSING

Microsoft Unveils Photosynth

Microsoft's livelabs were working on the Photosynth software from 2006. The Photosynth software pools together photos into synths that generates 3D panoramas of the same subject. During the preview phase, synths of the NASA shuttle Endeavor and the Piazza building at Rome could be viewed. On August 20, Photosynth was released for the common public, which allows users



to upload photos and create their own synths.

To use the Photosynth service, it is necessary to download an installation file from the Web site (www.photosynth.com). The installation has two components, a browser for viewing synths and a software for creating the synths.

The software works by identifying common elements in a bunch of photos, and creating a virtual three dimensional view of the subject, and placing the photos in the appropriate

positions depending on the angle at which the subject was photographed.

The 3D content that is generated is made up of dots, and looks highly pixelated, and rather grainy but still manages to give a clear picture of the subject. The more number of photographs a user takes of a subject, and in various angles, the more accurate will be the 3D generation.

The browser arranges all the photos of a subject in a 3D space and allows users to browse through them from their individual

points-of-view. The software works for buildings, works of sculpture, landscapes, small objects and even people's rooms. The service is proving popular with many synths containing upwards of a hundred and fifty photographs already up.

The software allows any user to theoretically create a complete 3D virtual imprint of anything. Currently, there is a 20 GB upload limit for any user, and the service is free of charge.

Once in a 3D environment, you can glide around the environment in different directions, smoothly zoom in or zoom out of the images, observe how the photos were clicked relative to one another, and if there is a large cluster of photographs from a lot of different angles, navigate the 3D scene smoothly with seeing very little of the 'generated' and grainy 3D content.